

Courtney Ko

San Francisco, CA • courtneyko.com • linkedin.com/in/courtneythko

Community builder and AI operator with a track record of growing technical communities from 0→1, producing high-signal hackathons and events for developer and researcher audiences, and translating AI product capabilities into genuine community experiences. Deep SF AI network, hands-on LLM and API experience, and the instinct to know what separates a high-signal gathering from a forgettable one.

EXPERIENCE

AI Valley

Chief Operating Officer

Sep 2025 – Present

San Francisco, CA

- Scaled a 0→1 developer community to **8,000+ engineers and founders** by designing high-signal technical programming — hackathons, workshops, and curated events — that earned a highly selective audience's recurring attendance.
- Launched an **all-women AI hackathon** (500+ registrations): owned format design, agenda, speaker curation, sponsor integration, and post-event follow-through end-to-end.
- Cultivated relationships with AI infrastructure companies (LLM API providers, dev tools) and translated their product capabilities into hands-on developer experiences that drove real-world adoption — not sponsor-driven slogs.
- Built and maintained a multi-sided community of builders, sponsors, and organizers; owned the 1:1 outreach, relationship development, and program feedback loops that kept the community alive between events.
- Developed champions and advocates within the SF AI community; identified high-engagement members and deepened those relationships into speakers, collaborators, and recurring contributors.

NVIDIA

Business Analyst, Software Operations

Oct 2025 – Present

Santa Clara, CA

- Led AI projects across the operations team, including building automation to generate not-for-resale orders — reducing processing time from **2 hours to 15 minutes** (87% reduction).
- Taught team members to use Codex and Claude Code to automate repetitive workflows, driving independent adoption of AI tooling across the org.
- Developed Python-based pipelines integrating Salesforce CLI data — hands-on experience with the CRM and operational tooling community managers rely on.

Pearle (AI Travel Platform)

Founder / Product Lead

Mar 2025 – Sep 2025

San Francisco, CA

- Built and launched a 0→1 AI-powered product, driving **3.9K+ user activations** in private beta through user research, community feedback loops, and hands-on LLM API integration.
- Shipped MVP in 10 weeks by coordinating engineering, design, and external partners — the same ownership and execution speed this role requires.

TipBrightly

Product Manager / Founding Product Manager

Jun 2020 – Oct 2025

San Francisco, CA

- Led 0→1 platform redesign driving 919% transaction growth (\$9.7K → \$99K); built instrumentation to track activation, retention, and growth metrics.
- Designed A/B experiments on onboarding and activation flows, increasing NPS to 78 — analytical discipline applied to community program measurement.

Wells Fargo

Design Producer (Product Design Program Manager)

Aug 2021 – Mar 2023

San Francisco, CA

- Standardized 100+ API and SDK documentation assets across 25+ products, improving developer onboarding — foundational understanding of developer GTM and technical audience needs.
- Led cross-functional delivery across 10+ stakeholders, aligning product, engineering, and design teams around shared milestones.

SKILLS

Community & Events: Technical event programming, hackathon design and execution, developer relations, community-led growth, advocate development, 1:1 outreach

Technical: Python, SQL, LLM APIs, NLP pipelines, API/SDK integrations, workflow automation, Salesforce

Research & Analytics: User research, A/B testing, funnel analysis, churn modeling, NPS, behavioral signal analysis

EDUCATION

M.A. Psychology — San Francisco State University

B.S. Cognitive Science — University of California, San Diego